

MUSIC

OVERVIEW

Music study at the Grade 11 and 12 level enhances students' understanding and appreciation of music through the development of practical skills and creative work. Students extend their creative problem-solving skills, individual and cooperative work habits, and knowledge of themselves and others. They develop a sense of personal responsibility and connections to their communities, and explore future careers.

Students use the elements of music (pitch – melody, harmony and tonality; duration – beat, metre, rhythm, and tempo; dynamics and other expressive controls; timbre; texture; and form) to create and perform works of increasing complexity. They use a variety of current technologies with increasing skill when practising, performing, composing, arranging, or recording music.

Performance and theory skills continue to be of major importance as students progress from grade to grade. Students extend their ability to evaluate performances by reviewing and reflecting and commenting on their own and others' creative work. They expand their specialized vocabulary for evaluating their own music and the work of other musicians.

The expectations for music courses are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to apply their skills and knowledge of theory to performance and composition. Students develop their technical skill when performing individually and in ensembles (e.g., using voice, band instruments, string instruments, guitar, keyboards, or other performance media). They improvise, interpret, and compose music, using a variety of media, such as computers and other digital technology.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** Using the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) to enhance their appreciation of different types of music enables students to develop a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live. Students listen to and reflect on live and recorded performances to develop their understanding of the language of music and assess how effectively composers and performers communicate to their audience. Students explore the interrelationship between music and society, drawing on music from a range of cultures, including the rich heritage of Canadian music. Students also assess their interest, skills, and knowledge in relation to potential careers or continued study in music.

3. **Foundations:** In this strand, students enhance their knowledge of and their ability to apply the symbols, concepts, and conventions used in music. Students build on the vocabulary necessary for creating, performing, and evaluating music. This foundational study helps them expand their understanding of the development of different musical forms and the importance of health and safety practices. Students also develop their understanding of musical etiquette and of ethical issues that apply to both consumers and producers of music.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.

The list of approved focus courses for Music can be found at:

www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Music, Grade 11

Open

AMU30

This course develops students' musical literacy through performance and the preparation and presentation of music productions. Students will perform works at a level consistent with previous experience. Independently and collaboratively, students will use current technology and the creative and critical analysis processes to plan, produce, present, and market musical productions. Students will respond to, reflect on, and analyse music from various genres and periods, and they will develop skills transferable to other aspects of their life and their careers.

Prerequisite: None

A. CREATING AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the stages of the creative process when performing music, composing and/or arranging music, and creating a musical production;
- A2. The Elements of Music:** apply elements of music when performing music and composing and/or arranging music;
- A3. Techniques and Technologies:** use a variety of techniques and technological tools when engaged in musical creation, production, and/or performance.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** apply the creative process when performing music and composing and/or arranging music (*e.g., generate ideas for a musical composition based on a video game; experiment with various natural and instrumental sounds when arranging music for their ensemble; explore and reflect on different arrangements of the same work; revise aspects of their performance based on feedback from peers*)

Teacher prompts: “What musical choices will you need to make in this performance? How can the creative process help you make effective choices?” “What roles do imagination and planning play in your preparation for a performance?”

- A1.2** apply the creative process when creating a musical production (*e.g., when planning, revising, and presenting a concert with your ensemble; when planning for, producing, and editing a recording of a small ensemble*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you need to consider when planning for the instruments or voices you are using in your production?” “How might you incorporate innovation into your production?” “Which stages of the creative process did you follow when working on this production?” “What are the potential pitfalls for performances or productions that do not follow the stages of the creative process?”

A2. The Elements of Music

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** apply the elements of music and related concepts appropriately when interpreting and performing notated music (*e.g., reproduce accurately, by clapping, playing, or singing, rhythms that are similar to those in the music they are studying; play or sing repertoire with accurate pitch and intonation; play or sing repertoire with correct dynamics and articulation; perform in an ensemble setting with uniform tonal blend and balanced dynamic intensity*)

Teacher prompts: “Considering the timbres of the various instruments in your ensemble, how might you ensure appropriate balance and blend?” “If the tempo of this song were altered, how might you change your approach to articulation?”

- A2.2** apply the elements of music and related concepts appropriately when composing and/or arranging music (*e.g., apply elements such as pitch [melody], timbre, and texture in their composition in a way similar to that in the popular music they are studying; use guitar tablature to notate pitches in a solo composition; arrange pieces of music in simple, binary, and free forms*)

Teacher prompts: “What would be some advantages of using guitar tablature as opposed to ‘standard’ notation? What limitations might this tablature have with respect to expressing the elements of music?” “How might the timbres of the instruments in your group affect the way you use the elements of duration and dynamics in your composition?”

A3. Techniques and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 demonstrate technical skill when performing music and/or creating a musical production (e.g., accurately and proficiently perform scales, patterns, or technical exercises in support of repertoire; demonstrate technical skills when recording their performances or those of their classmates or using a loop-based composition program to mix audio)

Teacher prompt: “How does competence in performing scales and technical exercises support your ability to perform repertoire?”

A3.2 use compositional techniques and available technology when composing and/or arranging music (e.g., compose a soundtrack in ABA form for a scene in a play, using a loop-based mixing program; use computer software to produce a rhythm section accompaniment for an instrumental or vocal solo)

Teacher prompts: “What software experience do you have that might help you use these music programs?” “How can you use software to address issues of balance and blend in your arrangement?” “How can you use software to help you implement your musical ideas?”

A3.3 use current technology to create a record of their own or their peers’ performance and/or production (e.g., collect examples of their best work in digital format and create a performance archive; create and publish digital video of their group’s best performances)

Teacher prompts: “What technical considerations do you need to address when creating your performance archive?” “How can watching a video recording of your performance help you assess your strengths and weaknesses?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process when responding to, analysing, reflecting on, and interpreting music;
- B2. Music and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of the role and impact of traditional, commercial, and art music within various communities and cultures;
- B3. Skills and Personal Growth:** demonstrate an understanding of how performing, creating, and critically analysing music has affected their skills and personal development;
- B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** identify and describe opportunities and requirements for continued engagement in music.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** listen to and/or perform selections that represent a wide variety of musical genres and styles, and describe and reflect on their responses to them (*e.g., document their initial reactions to more than one version of the same Leonard Cohen song; describe their response to several selections of music they like, and identify any common traits; describe the emotions conveyed in a work by a composer from the Romantic period*)

Teacher prompts: “Why might your opinion of a musical work, artist, or genre change over time?” “Describe the evolution of your personal listening history. What attracted you to each successive musical style?”

- B1.2** analyse productions such as concerts, recitals, musical theatre, and/or other musical events with reference to the elements and other components of music as well as the technical and organizational aspects of the production (*e.g., the human and technical resources required for a musical theatre production; the interplay of the elements of music in a performance by a string*

ensemble; the contribution of the elements of music to the aesthetic impact of a performance by a marching band)

Teacher prompts: “Have you created a flow chart showing the roles of all the participants in the talent show you are organizing? Are the roles clearly defined and complementary?” “Which elements of music contributed to the success (or lack of success) of this production?” “What non-musical aspects of a musical performance can be analysed using the critical analysis process?”

- B1.3** assess the effectiveness of a variety of musical selections and/or productions (*e.g., communicate their response to a community concert, including their assessment of its effectiveness in meeting the needs of the community; write a review of a musical theatre production; assess the appropriateness of a musical program with respect to its intention and audience*)

Teacher prompts: “What features of the small ensemble recital were effective from your point of view?” “Which member(s) of the cast of this musical production gave the most effective performance? What are the reasons for your opinion?”

B2. Music and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 identify and explain the interrelationships between traditional, commercial, and art music in specific cultures or communities (e.g., *the integration of elements of traditional music from multiple cultures into commercial music in Canada; the use of Hungarian folk songs in the work of art music composers from that country*)

Teacher prompts: “Who are some art music composers who have benefited from a strong folk music tradition in their culture? What impact has this tradition had on their music?” “What elements of traditional music can you identify in the music you hear around you in a typical day?”

B2.2 describe significant contributions of individuals, groups, or organizations within a community or culture to presentation and production aspects of traditional, commercial, and art music (e.g., *how groups and individuals such as the Rolling Stones, Michael Jackson, Madonna, or Rush have contributed to the format of large-scale music concerts popular in the West; how the East Coast Music Awards provide a vehicle for and encourage musicians from Atlantic Canada; how John Hammond helped broaden the audience for African-American musicians in the 1930s; how the concepts and intent of the salon music of Schubert and his contemporaries are reflected in modern-day performance and production practices*)

Teacher prompts: “What evidence do you hear of a cross-pollination of traditional, commercial, and art music in the music of Great Big Sea?” “How has the work of Andrew Lloyd Webber influenced the production and presentation of musical theatre?”

B2.3 explain the role of traditional, commercial, and/or art music in various communities or cultures (e.g., *the use of commercial music in advertising; how certain urban or rural communities have been stereotyped by the music they produce or listen to; how concerts can bring together a community*)

Teacher prompts: “What role has French-Canadian music played in maintaining a distinct francophone culture in Canada?” “In what ways do musical styles and preferences define and express the concerns of various youth communities?”

B3. Skills and Personal Growth

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 explain how the study of music has contributed to their self-awareness, their values, their ability to express themselves, and their understanding of others (e.g., *how exposure to the values expressed in contemporary music has shaped or reinforced their values or behaviour; how honing their performance, production, and creative skills has enabled them to express themselves more effectively; how musical activities have contributed to their knowledge and understanding of the communities or cultures of their peers*)

Teacher prompts: “What aspects of the study of music have enhanced your ability to express yourself?” “How has studying music from a variety of cultures affected your identity?”

B3.2 identify and analyse their musical production and performance skills and knowledge, and describe the steps they will take to ensure continued improvements in these areas (e.g., *critique their own performance from a technical or aesthetic perspective, and identify areas for improvement; reflect regularly on their rehearsal of a selection in order to identify areas for improvement; develop and carry out a practice strategy for overcoming a performance weakness; review their contributions to group planning or production meetings, and identify how they could improve their personal input*)

Teacher prompt: “What contribution have you made to ensuring the success of this production? Are there any areas you found particularly challenging and/or where you had to enlist the help of your peers? How could you improve your skills in these areas?”

B3.3 demonstrate leadership and collaborative skills when planning, promoting, producing, and performing in a variety of musical presentations (e.g., *facilitate and participate in group planning processes; follow protocols for effective meetings; consult with the other members of their ensemble or production team, listen meaningfully, and reflect on their ideas; devise and implement innovative ideas to promote a performance*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to build trust when working as part of a team?” “When your ensemble is preparing for a recital, what skills are most likely to ensure success?”

B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B4.1 identify and describe the skills and knowledge required to pursue careers connected to the arts and culture industry (e.g., *describe possible music industry careers and the requirements for specific jobs; use a career-profiling website to assess their own interests, skills, and aspirations and match these with appropriate careers in the cultural industry; investigate the skills required for careers that support musicians and composers, such as artist management, instrument making or repair, music promotion and marketing, recording or sound engineering*)

Teacher prompts: “Based on your current interests, skills, and level of knowledge, what music-related career could you pursue that would provide an adequate living?” “What types of jobs does the production of a large-scale musical generate? What skills do these jobs require?”

B4.2 describe educational pathways that would enable them to prepare for careers in planning, promoting, producing, and/or performing in musical presentations (e.g., *conduct a live or electronic interview with a music producer or promoter in their community, focusing on the educational prerequisites and ongoing learning requirements for the field; create a promotional poster for a postsecondary school of music that illustrates possible careers associated with its music program*)

Teacher prompts: “What non-music courses would help you acquire skills and knowledge related to the promotion or production of musical presentations?” “How might you assess the value or appropriateness of a course or program in music?”

B4.3 identify opportunities for, and explain the benefits of, participating in and attending musical endeavours of various types (e.g., *performances of various types of music in their school or community; opportunities for performance by their band, choir, ensemble; possible venues for performance or presentation of musical work, such as parks, town halls, hospitals, elementary or nursery schools, or other non-traditional spaces; music-related activities and other services offered by local or regional arts councils*)

Teacher prompts: “Where might you look for information about folk, jazz, and/or international music festivals in the community?” “Describe how you can use radio, television, and/or podcasts to access music that you are unable to hear live.” “What supports exist that could assist young musicians in building a profile in your community?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Theory and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of music theory with respect to the elements and other components of music, and use appropriate terminology relating to them;
- C2. Musical Genres and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of musical genres, periods, and themes, and the influence of the environment on different forms of music;
- C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of responsible practices and performance conventions relating to music.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Theory and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology relating to, the elements of music when planning, promoting, producing, and performing in a music production or presentation (e.g., *describe in detail the elements of music in their performance repertoire; analyse the interrelationship of pitch, duration, and dynamics in a particular musical production, and identify the acoustical aspects of a performance venue that would best support these elements; describe the types of tasks and personnel [types of musicians, sound engineers] required to support the elements in a musical production; list the physical resources required to support the elements of music, such as acoustic or electronic instruments, amplification, sound baffling, computer technologies*)
- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of, and use proper terminology when referring to, aspects of musical form in a variety of genres (e.g., *riffs in blues; themes in orchestral music; vocables in North American Aboriginal songs; themes associated with movie characters in film scores; overtures, arias, duets, choruses in opera*)
- C1.3** identify melodic, harmonic, and rhythmic patterns, and reproduce them accurately, by playing, singing, or notating them (e.g., *reproduce, aurally identify, and notate examples of intervals from unison to an octave; reproduce, aurally identify, and notate examples of major and minor triads in root position; notate examples of rhythm patterns appropriate to the repertoire being studied*)

C2. Musical Genres and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** categorize various musical works by genre, period, and function and/or theme, and describe the reasons for their categorization (e.g., *categorize selected art music as a symphony, concerto, or sonata, and give reasons for their decisions; distinguish between Gregorian chant and chants in South Asian ragas; describe the differences between rock music and rhythm and blues; describe the genres of music in a range of music videos*)
Teacher prompt: "What era and genre of twentieth-century popular music do you believe this selection represents? What musical characteristics led you to this conclusion?"
- C2.2** describe, in a research-based report or presentation, the interrelationship between nature/the environment and various kinds of music, including Aboriginal music (e.g., *present a ritual or celebration using replica instruments created from natural or recycled materials; investigate how composers have used nature as a source of inspiration and ideas*)
Teacher prompts: "What attitudes towards the environment are evident in traditional and contemporary Aboriginal music?" "How does Stravinsky represent nature in *Rite of Spring*? What are some other art music compositions that were inspired by nature?" "How can music connect us to the environment?"

C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** explain the importance of safe and healthy practices for preventing performance- and production-related injuries and for maintaining respiratory, aural, and vocal health (*e.g., safe practices associated with performing on stage; ways to protect their hearing when playing or listening to loud music; warm-up exercises prior to playing an instrument or singing*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some potential dangers associated with practising or performing on stage?” “Why do vocalists do warm-up exercises before performing?”

- C3.2** describe and demonstrate conventions associated with music performances and productions, from the perspective of a performer and an audience member (*e.g., compile a detailed list of audience etiquette for different types of musical performances; compare and contrast the programs for different types of concerts and explain the reasons for the differences*)

Teacher prompts: “Is it appropriate to clap after a song in a musical theatre presentation? After a movement of a concerto?” “What sorts of behaviour by audience members can disturb performers or other audience members? What can you do to ensure you do not disturb the performance or other people’s enjoyment of it?” “What strategies can performers use to connect with the audience during a concert?”

- C3.3** demonstrate an understanding of ethical and legal issues related to music, with respect to both consumers and producers and with particular emphasis on issues related to the entertainment industry (*e.g., debate issues related to the protection of the rights of composers/performers, the availability of music on the Internet, and illegal downloading and file sharing*)

Teacher prompt: “How has the distribution of recorded music changed over the past twenty-five years? What legal problems have these changes created for the recording industry?”